Wayne Kim

Product Designer, Games and Play

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I make games more fun by watching real people play them. I take play from concept to a finished, tested object through fast prototyping and playtesting, with cardboard, CAD, 3D printing, and electronics. Seven years of consumer research at Designit and startups, then a Master's in Interaction Design at CIID.

SELECTED GAMES AND PRODUCTS

Bureau of Sanctioned Sketching | Party drawing card game, designer (solo) — CIID · 2025

- Designed a party game for adults who say they can't draw. The core mechanic: one card from each of three stacks (Draw, Using, While) sets a one-minute round on a shared sheet. Added blank wildcards after watching players write their own prompts.
- Built 6 prototypes in 8 weeks, from an Arduino rainstick to hand-tracking software. Players got stuck on the technology, so I moved the strongest mechanics into a card deck.
- Ran 2 playtests with 8 players, where players forgot the cards and kept drawing. Grounded in 14 interviews and a 47-person survey. Finished as a deck with box design and a quick-start written as "official procedure."

Toilet Paper Elevator | Physical product, designer and maker (solo) — Personal · 2026

- In a 14-day sprint, modeled the pod, sleeve, and cable raceway in CAD (Fusion 360) and 3D printed them; wired a Hall effect sensor, e-paper screen, and battery to an Arduino; then designed the screens and tested them with people.

Linee | Tactile timekeeper for shared homes, team of 3 — CIID · 2025

- Laser-cut wooden object. I wrote the motor and LED code, prototyped the blocks, and proposed the magnetic tiles.

EXPERIENCE

Independent | Interaction Designer · Los Angeles, CA — Sept 2025 – Present

- Designing and building physical prototypes with Arduino, CAD, and 3D printing. Learning SolidWorks alongside hardware startups at LACI.

Glorify | Senior Design Researcher · Los Angeles, CA — Feb 2023 – Feb 2024

- Watched 82 people use a prototype in their real small groups for two weeks; 65% were still active at week two.
- Turned what I saw into three design principles. The company launched Glorify Groups, which now has 1.8M+ users.
- Built the research practice and grew the team from one researcher to three.

Designit | Design Researcher · Remote / New York, NY — Aug 2021 – Jan 2023

- Led end-to-end mixed-methods consumer research for Fortune 500 clients.
- Designed and facilitated a 3-day, 60-person workshop that turned C-suite priorities into product strategy.

RaiseMe | UX Strategist · San Francisco, CA — Dec 2017 – Jun 2020

- Interviewed and observed college partners, which led to rebuilding how 330+ colleges got their data and cut a weekly task from 15 minutes to 2.

Earlier — 2015 – 2021

- Research and design for Y Combinator companies (2020 – 2021). Reed College, Assistant Dean of Admission: built a program from 0 to 1, grew applicants 8x.

EDUCATION

Copenhagen Institute of Interaction Design (CIID) | Master's in Interaction Design — Sept 2024 – Aug 2025

Colby College | B.A. in Sociology — Sept 2010 – May 2014

SKILLS

Game and play design: gameplay mechanics, rules writing, paper and card prototyping, playtest facilitation, consumer research

Making: model making, CAD (Fusion 360, SolidWorks), 3D printing, laser cutting, Arduino, sensors and electronics

Tools: Figma, Processing, TouchDesigner, Python, Resolume, Cursor, Claude Code

Outside work: surfing, VJing, museums, and designing shirts for my favorite kebab shop